

Bernice Fisher

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EDUCATION

University of Washington | *B.S. Computer Science*

2012 - 2015

- Coursework in distributed systems, database design, and performance optimization

EXPERIENCE

Stripe | *Staff Platform Engineer*

Aug 2021 - Present

- Architected multi-region Kubernetes infrastructure supporting 40+ internal services, reducing deployment latency by 65% and enabling zero-downtime updates for 500+ daily deployments across 8 teams.
- Led cross-functional initiative to migrate observability stack from Datadog to open-source Prometheus/Grafana, cutting annual monitoring costs by \$2.3M while improving MTTR from 45 to 12 minutes.
- Mentored 7 junior and mid-level engineers on platform reliability patterns, conducting weekly deep-dives on distributed systems that influenced architecture decisions across Payment Orchestration and Risk teams.

Uber | *Senior Platform Engineer*

Mar 2019 - Jul 2021

- Designed and operationalized service mesh control plane (Envoy-based) handling 120K+ RPS across ride-sharing and delivery platforms, achieving 99.99% availability and reducing inter-service latency variance by 40%.
- Established platform standards for CI/CD pipelines that reduced average build times from 25 to 8 minutes for 200+ microservices, improving developer productivity and enabling 10x increase in deployment frequency.
- Drove database connection pooling optimization reducing connection churn by 89%, preventing 3 major production incidents and saving \$1.8M annually in cloud infrastructure costs.

Databricks | *Lead Infrastructure Engineer*

Jun 2017 - Feb 2019

- Owned platform reliability SLOs across all compute clusters, implementing predictive autoscaling that reduced emergency scaling events by 72% and improved query performance consistency by 55% for 500+ enterprise customers.
- Architected internal developer platform (IDP) abstractions enabling self-service infrastructure provisioning, reducing time-to-deployment for data pipeline teams from 2 weeks to 2 hours.
- Resolved critical etcd corruption incident affecting 15 clusters affecting 50K+ nodes by implementing automated consensus recovery tooling, preventing future incidents and reducing MTBF from 6 months to 24 months.

Square | *Senior Platform Engineer*

Jan 2015 - May 2017

- Migrated monolithic payment processor to event-driven architecture across 6 services, achieving 3x throughput increase (from 8K to 24K TPS) and improving system resilience during peak transaction volumes.
- Designed and implemented chaos engineering framework that proactively identified 23 production failure scenarios, leading 12 reliability improvements across core payment path before affecting customers.
- Led quarterly platform engineering guild meetings for 45+ backend engineers, establishing best practices for rate-limiting, circuit breakers, and health checks that prevented 6 major outages.

PROJECTS

Platform Standardization Initiative | *Kubernetes, Helm, Argo Workflows, CNCF tools*

2022 - 2023

- Established organization-wide platform standards and golden paths reducing team onboarding time by 60% and enabling consistent observability across 120+ services.
- Created reusable Helm charts and Terraform modules adopted by 18 teams, standardizing infrastructure-as-code practices and reducing configuration drift incidents by 94%.

EXTRACURRICULAR

Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF) | *Technical Advisory Board Contributor*

2021 - Present

- Contributed to Kubernetes community working groups, providing platform engineering perspective on API design decisions reviewed by 50+ maintainers.
- Authored white paper on platform engineering maturity models downloaded 8K+ times, establishing thought leadership in infrastructure reliability space.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages – Go, Python, Rust, Java, Bash, SQL

Technologies – Kubernetes, Docker, Envoy, Istio, etcd, PostgreSQL, Cassandra, Elasticsearch, Apache Kafka, Protocol Buffers, gRPC

Tools – Terraform, Prometheus, Grafana, PagerDuty, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, ELK Stack, Vault